

RITUALS

A ritual is what keeps the team pointing at the same place when nobody is watching.

Which ones the team really needs, and which have already died.

THE QUESTION OF THIS PIECE

A dead ritual charges the same time and gives nothing back.

THE CASCADE

How a ritual becomes scenery.



WHAT YOU SEE

Someone booked it under a previous manager...



THE MECHANISM

...the meeting keeps happening with no owner and no agenda...



THE CONSEQUENCE

...and the team attends with the camera off, filling a slot.

Nobody cancels what they inherited, because nobody feels like its owner.

THE FORK

A live ritual does three things.

A LIVE RITUAL

01

It corrects someone's route, every single time.

02

It surfaces what would not be said otherwise.

03

If nothing changes after it, it has already died.

The question is not whether the ritual happens, it is what changes because of it.

THE METHOD

The four minimum rituals.

01 **DIRECTION**

where we are going and what the priority is now

02 **RESULTS**

the number on the table, and the route change it demands

03 **HARD CONVERSATION**

what is not working, said before it becomes a grudge

04 **RECOGNITION**

telling what someone did, with a name and an audience

Four rituals are enough. The fifth is usually inherited from a previous manager.

IN PRACTICE, IN ORDER

Frequency, length and what comes out of it.

01 • DIRECTION

Direction, monthly.

one hour, out comes the month's priority, written in one line

02 • RESULTS

Results, weekly.

thirty minutes, out comes the adjustment call, not the report

03 • HARD
CONVERSATION

Hard conversation, biweekly.

forty minutes, out comes an agreement about behavior

04 •
RECOGNITION

Recognition, continuous.

two minutes in any meeting, with a fact and a name

TWO MODELS

A live ritual or a dead routine.

THE COMMON MODEL

Dead routine

Happens because it is on the calendar

Everyone reports what is already known

Nobody leaves with a task

Cancelling it would change nothing

THE DESIGNED MODEL

Live ritual

Happens because it changes something

Someone brings what was stuck

A decision comes out with an owner

The team complains if it gets cancelled

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three ways to hollow out the meeting.

01 The manager talking eighty percent of the time.

- it becomes an announcement, and that needs nobody in a room.

02 Turning it into slide reading.

- if it can be read alone, send the text and hand the hour back.

03 Punishing whoever brought the problem.

- next time nobody brings it, and the ritual becomes good news theater.

What you do with the first piece of bad news defines the rest of the year.

THE CHAIN

The missing week test.

01

Cancel one ritual for a whole month.



02

Nobody missed it or asked about it?



03

It was already dead, and you just recovered hours.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

If the team complains about the absence, you have proof the ritual is alive.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

How to trim and revive the team's calendar.



STEP 01

Sort the current meetings into the four types.

whatever fits none of them is a candidate for the missing week test



STEP 02

Define what has to come out of each ritual.

a decision, an agreement or a priority, always something concrete



STEP 03

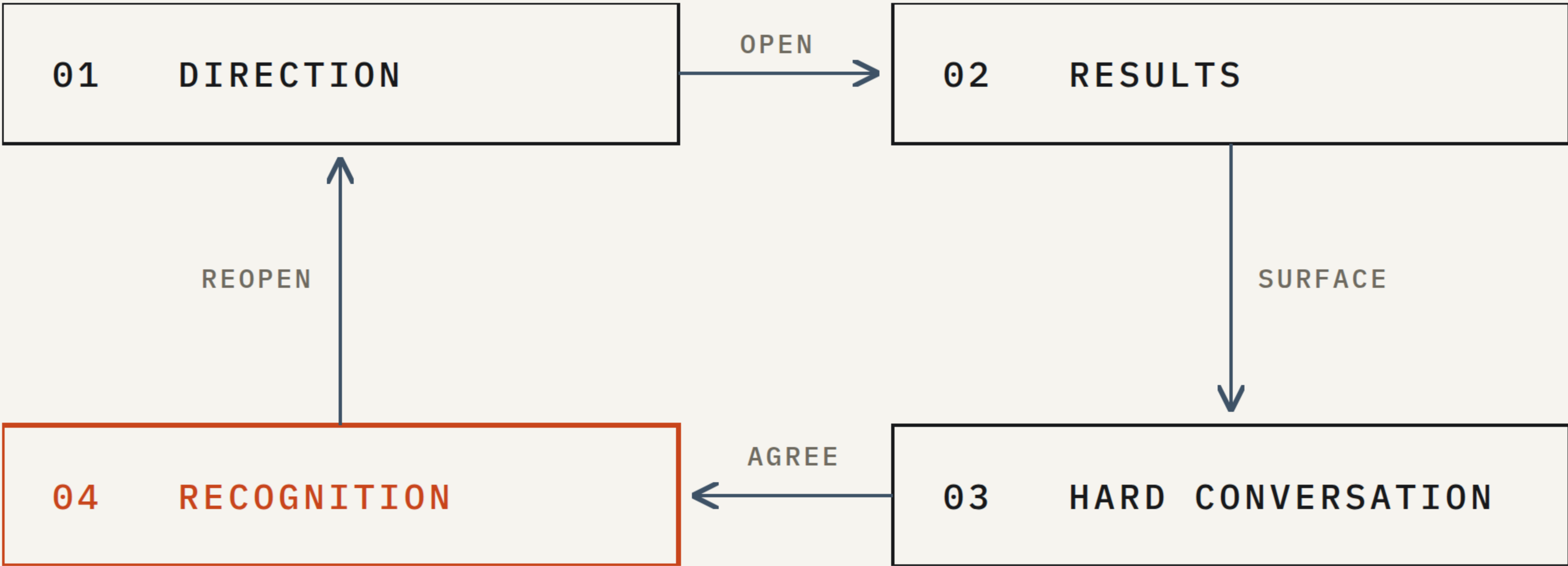
Change the format of one of them this week.

swapping who runs it usually revives the most tired ritual

| A ritual nobody would miss is stealing time from what matters.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Four Minimum Rituals, a loop and not a list.



A ritual that changes nothing is a routine eating the team.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER
in your next review of the team's calendar.

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